

background colour, global lighting, exposure, and environmental effects. It is accessed from the main menu by choosing Rendering > Environment.

5.5.1 Background

The background of the scene can be configured by using the Environment map. The background can be a colour or a map. The map can be a bitmap or any 3ds Max 2D procedural map. The map can be dragged into the Material Editor as an instance to set mapping styles. The map defaults to screen mapping, which simply stretches the map to fill the screen. You can also map it as a spherical, shrink-wrap, or cylindrical environment.

5.5.2 Exposure Control

Exposure Control is a process that allows you to fine-tune an image as it is rendered. This process can be used for any scanline-rendered scene. It treats the rendered image like a film negative and allows you to adjust exposure they way film let's you. It can be helpful in matching rendered scenes to live action. Those who use radiosity will find that exposure control is almost a necessity. Radiosity rendered scenes can have a wide dynamic range and exposure control can help bring this wide variation in lighting into a more-useable image.

5.5.3 Environmental effects

Environmental effects are added by using the Effects rollout at the bottom of the environment panel. Environmental effects are volumetric (such as fog and fire). Effects can be stacked in the Effects list, and the effects will be evaluated from bottom to top. Fog causes objects to fade as they recede from the camera. The Environment Ranges settings in the camera control how the fog is rendered. Volume Fog creates fog within a specified volume. It is good for creating misty environments or cloudlike effects. A gizmo helper object specifies the volume for the effect. Fire Effect can produce animated fire, smoke, and explosion effects. It can be used for fire, explosion, and nebula-type



Recreate trees with environmental effects